

ADVANCED WATER SAFETY

Student Lesson Outline | Year 9-10 | Victorian Curriculum F-10 Version 2.0

6-lesson unit overview with learning intentions, success criteria, key vocabulary, and end-of-lesson reflection prompts for each lesson.

STUDENT NAME	CLASS	TEACHER
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Unit Overview

By end of unit you will KNOW	By end of unit you will UNDERSTAND	By end of unit you will DO
Victorian & global drowning rates Physiology of drowning & CPR Social determinants of risk Prevention strategy evidence International water safety approaches Diving & spinal injury data	Why data alone does not prevent drowning How structural factors create unequal risk Why some strategies work and others do not The link between community action and safety Why false confidence near water is a structural problem	Calculate & interpret drowning rate statistics Evaluate prevention evidence & justify decisions Compare international approaches Analyse spinal injury data structurally Design an evidence-based health product Argue a health policy position using real data

Prerequisite knowledge:

This unit builds on Year 7-8 water safety. You should already know: beach flags, DRS ABCD, the 5 SwimSafe rules, rip current escape, and basic Victorian drowning statistics. Speak to your teacher for a catch-up summary if needed.

1 Advanced Data Analysis — Victorian & Global Drowning Trends

Learning Intention

We are learning to calculate, compare, and critically interpret Victorian and global drowning statistics to understand who is most at risk and why.

Success Criteria

- I can calculate Victorian drowning rates per 100,000 population and compare them to the national average, showing all working. [VCHPEP144]
- I can analyse CALD over-representation in drowning data and explain at least two structural reasons — not individual ones. [VCHPEP143]
- I can create a correctly labelled bar graph from real LSV data and write a two-sentence interpretation. [VCHPEP144]

Key Vocabulary

drowning rate · CALD · over-representation · non-fatal drowning · unpatrolled · trend · demographic · disproportion

End-of-Lesson Reflection

Exit: In one sentence — what is the single most important data insight from today, and why does it matter?

2 Physiology of Drowning & CPR Mechanics

Learning Intention

We are learning to explain the physiological sequence of drowning and justify why early bystander CPR is the single most important factor in survival outcomes.

Success Criteria

- I can describe the correct drowning sequence using all five terms: submersion, hypoxia, laryngospasm, cardiac arrest, cerebral hypoxia. [VCHPEP144]
- I can explain in plain language why starting CPR within 4 minutes produces significantly better outcomes, using the terms cardiac output and oxygenated blood. [VCHPEM162]
- I can explain what secondary drowning is and what action should be taken after any submersion incident. [VCHPEP144]

Key Vocabulary

hypoxia · laryngospasm · cardiac arrest · cerebral hypoxia · cardiac output · CPR 30:2 · secondary drowning · 1-10-1 rule

End-of-Lesson Reflection

Exit: Explain the 4-minute window to someone who has never heard of it — plain language, no medical jargon.

3 Social Determinants of Drowning Risk

Learning Intention

We are learning to analyse how social, cultural, and structural factors influence who drowns and why — moving beyond individual to systemic explanations.

Success Criteria

- I can identify at least three social determinants of drowning risk and explain the specific mechanism by which each one increases risk. [VCHPEP143]
- I can distinguish between individual explanations (personal behaviour) and structural explanations (systemic factors), using real Victorian data. [VCHPEP143]
- I can propose three specific, practical actions a Victorian school could take to reduce CALD drowning disproportionality — with enough detail to implement. [VCHPEP145]

Key Vocabulary

social determinants · structural factors · masculinity norms · socioeconomic status · health inequity · intersectionality · community capacity · correlation

End-of-Lesson Reflection

Exit: Name ONE social determinant a school CAN address and ONE it CANNOT. Why is that distinction important?

4 Prevention Strategies & International Comparison

Learning Intention

We are learning to evaluate drowning prevention strategies against evidence and compare Australian approaches to those used internationally.

Success Criteria

- I can evaluate five prevention strategies against evidence strength, target population, and key limitations. [VCHPEP144]
- I can compare the approaches of RLSSA, RLSS UK, and the American Red Cross, identifying at least one substantive difference. [VCHPEP148]
- I can argue, with evidence from at least one primary source with URL, whether a specific international approach should be adopted in Victoria. [VCHPEP148]

Key Vocabulary

evidence hierarchy · primary source · pool fencing · patrolled location · Float to Live · RLSSA · intervention · success metric

End-of-Lesson Reflection

Exit: Which ONE prevention strategy has the strongest evidence? Which has the weakest? Defend your answer.

5 Diving, Spinal Injuries & High-Risk Teenage Behaviour

Learning Intention

We are learning to analyse Australian data on diving-related spinal injury — identifying specific risk factors, population groups, and locations — and to evaluate prevention messages using an evidence-based framework.

Success Criteria

- I can explain, using AIHW data, why unsafe diving accounts for 10% of spinal cord injuries and 20% of quadriplegia cases in Australia, and identify the highest-risk age group. [VCHPEP144]
- I can analyse three 2024-25 Australian case studies (Terrigal, Torquay, Bawley Beach) and explain the specific mechanism — not just the behaviour — that caused injury in each. [VCHPEP143]
- I can construct a structural explanation for why 95% of aquatic spinal injury patients are male, using the social determinants framework. [VCHPEP143]
- I can evaluate the "Feet First, First Time" prevention message and propose a complementary strategy for a named high-risk group with a SMART metric. [VCHPEP145]

Key Vocabulary

cervical spine · quadriplegia · spinal cord injury · sandbank · tidal depth variation · false confidence · inland waterway · remote rescue delay · sediment · feet first first time · AIHW · RLSSA

End-of-Lesson Reflection

Exit: The highest incidence of diving spinal injury is in 10-14 year olds. What specific social and environmental factors explain this — and what would a targeted prevention response look like?

6 Assessment Task — Planning, Drafting & Peer Review

Learning Intention

We are learning to synthesise our unit knowledge into an evidence-based communication product that argues a clear position and proposes measurable outcomes.

Success Criteria

- I can produce a coherent draft including at least three credible sources with URLs and at least one accurate Victorian or global statistic. [VCHPEP148]
- I can clearly identify my target audience and demonstrate my product is designed specifically for them. [VCHPEP148]
- I can use the assessment checklist to peer-review a classmate's draft and provide two specific, constructive written suggestions. [VCHPEP144]

Key Vocabulary

Option A — Policy Brief (600-800 words to Minister) | Option B — Campaign (target one high-risk group) | Option C — School Audit (advanced)

End-of-Lesson Reflection

Unit reflection: What is the most important thing I learned that I did not know before? What question does this unit leave me wanting to investigate?

A Assessment Overview

All options must include	A-standard work	Key resources to cite
✓ At least 3 sources with URLs ✓ At least 1 Victorian or global statistic ✓ Clear target audience / addressee ✓ Specific, measurable call to action ✓ Connection to social determinant or physiological concept	Goes beyond description. Analyses, evaluates, and argues with evidence. Acknowledges counter-arguments. Proposes measurable outcomes. Cites primary sources. Written specifically for the named audience.	lsv.com.au/research royallifesaving.com.au who.int/drowning victoriancurriculum.vcaa.vic.edu.au rlss.org.uk/education redcross.org/water-safety